Unit 5

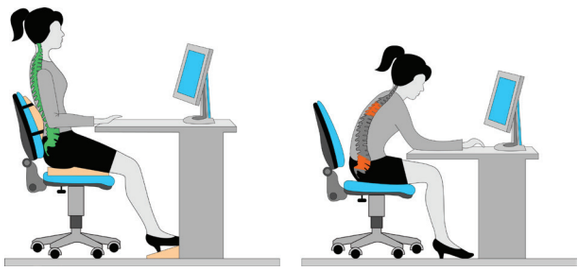
POSITIONS USED FOR PATIENTS

5.1 INTRODUCTION:

Nursing is a job that needs a lot of bending our backs, flexing our arms and legs and pushing and pulling patients. Because of this, many nurses are at risk for developing physical strain and back injuries or even fractures. One way to prevent these from happening is to practice proper body mechanics.

Definition

Body mechanics involves the coordinated effort of muscles, bones, and the nervous system to maintain balance, posture, and alignment during moving, transferring, and positioning patients. Proper body mechanics allows individuals to carry out activities without excessive use of energy, and helps prevent injuries for nurses and patients.



Purposes of good body mechanics and posture.

(1) To provide maximum comfort and relaxation.

(2) To aid in normal body function.

(3) To prevent contractures and neuromuscular deformities and complications.

(4) To conserve maximum possible energy by preventing unnecessary strain.



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